

Boarding Pass

PASSENGER:
AJAY

FLIGHT:
BC1234



FLIGHT FARES IN FOCUS

DATE:
04/16/2025

TIME:
14:45

GATE:
6

SEAT:
12A



0 35545 82336 78 1

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BOSTON



**SAN
FRANCISCO**

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0 00035 54562 0



MEET OUR TEAM



Aamir



Anisha



Surya



Bhavya



Yashaswini

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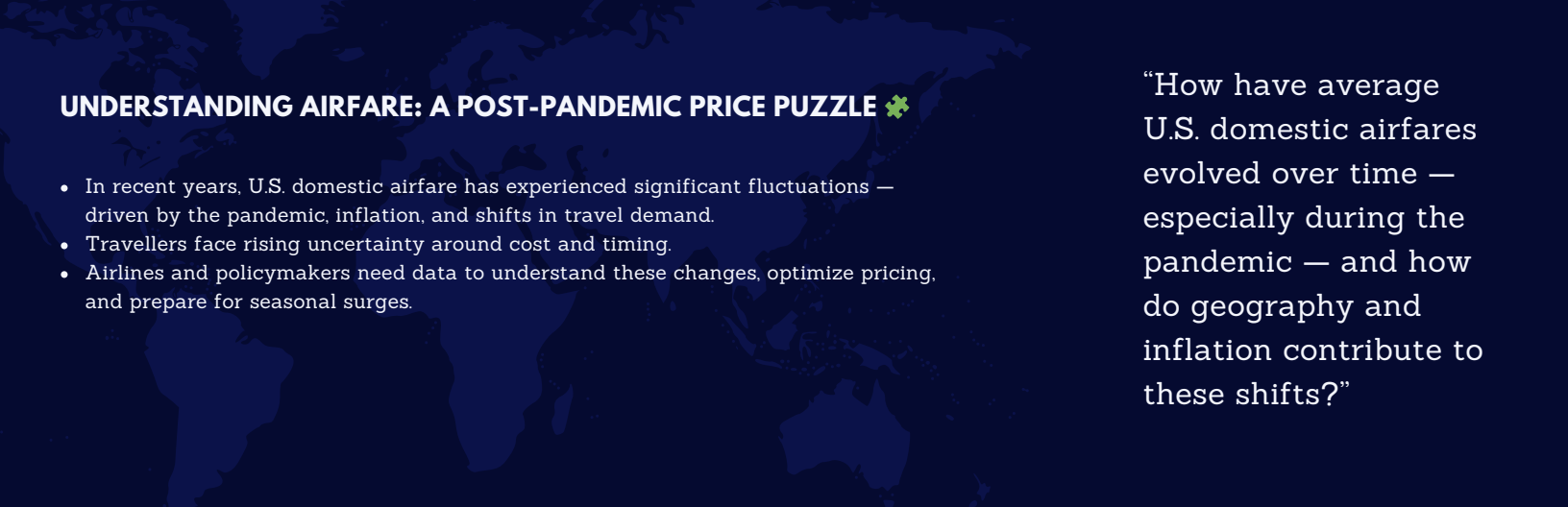
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6

SEAT:

12A



A dark blue world map is visible in the background, showing the outlines of continents and countries. The map is centered on the Atlantic Ocean, with North and South America on the left and Europe and Africa on the right.

UNDERSTANDING AIRFARE: A POST-PANDEMIC PRICE PUZZLE 🧩

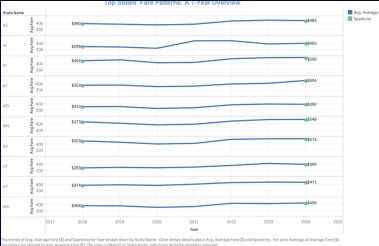
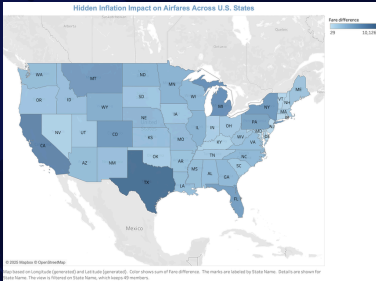
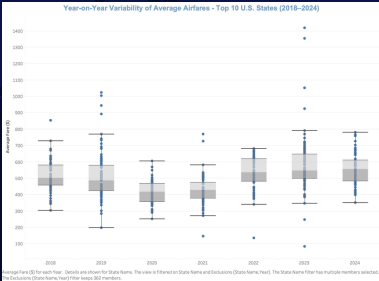
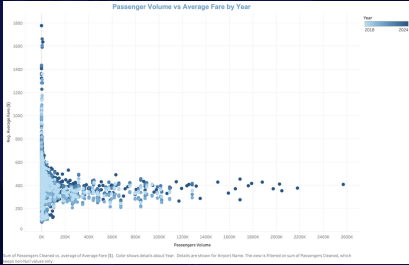
- In recent years, U.S. domestic airfare has experienced significant fluctuations — driven by the pandemic, inflation, and shifts in travel demand.
- Travellers face rising uncertainty around cost and timing.
- Airlines and policymakers need data to understand these changes, optimize pricing, and prepare for seasonal surges.

“How have average U.S. domestic airfares evolved over time — especially during the pandemic — and how do geography and inflation contribute to these shifts?”

“BEHIND THE DASHBOARD: THE DATA JOURNEY”

- Source: Bureau of Transportation Statistics (BTS) – Average Fare Data
- Years Covered: 2018 to 2024 (Annual + Quarterly)
- Scope: Over 3,000 records across 400+ U.S. airports
- Key Fields Used:
 - Airport Code, City, State
 - Rank (by passenger volume)
 - Average Fare & Inflation-Adjusted Fare
 - Passenger Sample (10%)
 - Period (Year/Quarter)

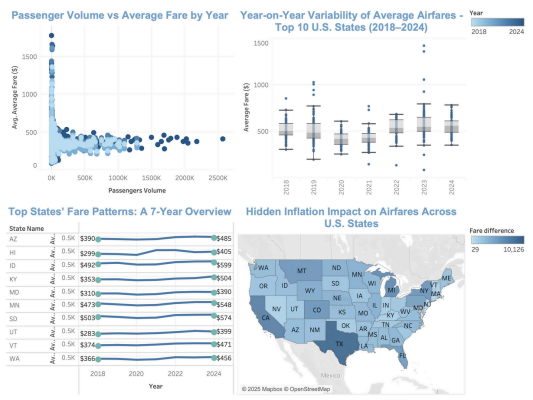




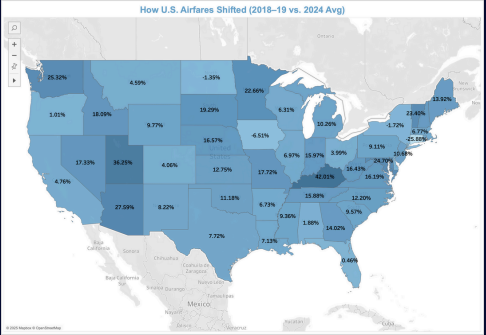
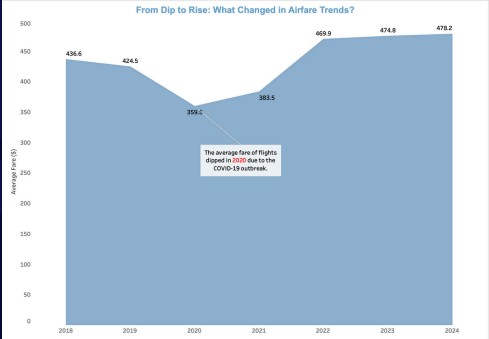
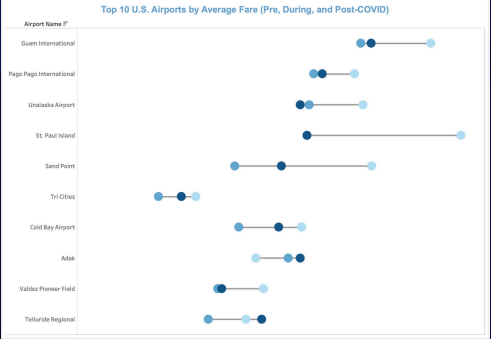
2018 to 2024

THE STORY IN THE SKIES: FARE EVOLUTION FROM 2018 TO 2024

- Airports with high passenger volume consistently offer lower fares, especially post-2021. Smaller, less-trafficked airports tend to charge higher prices due to limited routes and competition.
- While average fares dipped sharply in 2020, year-on-year variability has remained significant. Post-pandemic years (2022–2024) show more extreme fare outliers, particularly in remote regions.
- States like South Dakota, Minnesota, and Idaho experienced substantial fare increases over time, while others like Hawaii and Vermont showed relatively stable pricing.
- Inflation-adjusted fare differences reveal that Texas, California, and New York saw the largest increases in real travel costs, while many Midwestern and Southern states maintained affordability.
- Overall, airfare trends from 2018–2024 show how traffic volume, location, and inflation shape the real cost of travel across the country.

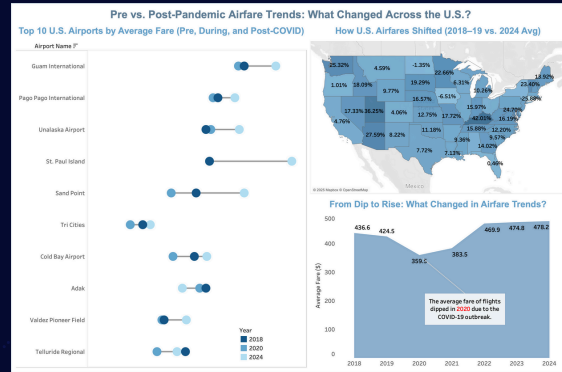


Pre vs. Post Pandemic ✈️



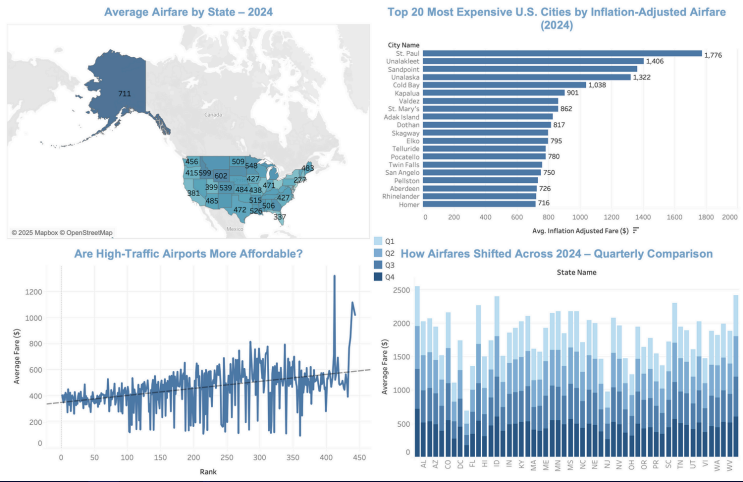
PRE VS. POST PANDEMIC: HOW U.S. AIRFARE CHANGED

- The average U.S. airfare dropped from \$424 in 2019 to \$359 in 2020, marking the steepest single-year decline due to the COVID-19 outbreak.
- By 2022, fares surged back to pre-pandemic levels, with steady growth continuing into 2023 and 2024.
- Remote airports like St. Paul Island, Sand Point, and Unalaska showed sharp fare increases post-COVID — reflecting limited access and route constraints.
-
- The regional impact of the pandemic varied:
 - Kentucky (+42%), Arizona (+36%), and New Mexico (+27%) saw the highest fare jumps.
 - Massachusetts (-25%) and Minnesota (-6%) were among the few with fare decreases compared to 2018–19 averages.
- These shifts reveal how the pandemic reshaped fare structures — especially for underserved airports and inland states.



FROM WINTER LOWS TO HOLIDAY HIGHS: 2024 FARE BREAKDOWN

- In 2024, average airfares peaked in Q2 and Q4 across most U.S. states — aligning with summer vacations and holiday travel seasons.
- Q1 fares were consistently the lowest, suggesting off-season discounts and lower demand.
- States like Colorado, Florida, and Hawaii showed the highest seasonal fare spikes, especially in Q2.
- Meanwhile, states such as Ohio, Michigan, and Pennsylvania had relatively stable fares across all four quarters.
- These seasonal trends reveal how geography and travel demand influence dynamic airfare pricing — a critical insight for both consumers and airlines.



TURNING INSIGHT INTO ACTION: OUR RECOMMENDATIONS

For Airlines:

- Adjust fare strategy to accommodate regional seasonality — increase capacity or promotions during off-peak quarters.
- Improve affordability at high-cost, low-volume airports through partnerships or service expansions.
- Use inflation-adjusted insights to benchmark pricing decisions more accurately.

For Planners & Policymakers:

- Focus infrastructure and budget planning around Q2 and Q4 peaks.
- Address fare inequality in underserved regions to support equitable access to travel.
- Monitor fare inflation in key states (e.g., Texas, Arizona) for long-term transit planning.

For Travelers:

- Consider booking in Q1 or Q3 to avoid peak fare spikes in Q2 and Q4.
- Compare nearby airports within the same region — prices can vary significantly due to volume and location.
- Watch for remote airports with higher-than-average fares even in off-season periods.



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“THANK YOU FOR FLYING WITH US”

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